Even security and survival, those existential questions that once “called forth daring, courage, imagination, and idealism,” are now far more prosaic. The violence of the past few years, from the Gaza war to the “stabbing intifada”, was handled in a pragmatic fashion: investments in missile defense and tunnel detection systems; more officers on the streets; and more economic investment in restive communities. There are no more heroic wars, no iconic photographs of paratroopers liberating the Western Wall. Israel approaches its endless conflicts much like the mayor of New York deals with the murder rate.

There is one final divide in Western politics, and it may ultimately be the most decisive: a generational one. Young people overwhelmingly rejected Brexit. Just 25 per cent of those under the age of twenty-four wanted to leave, compared with 80 per cent of pensioners. If only millennials had voted in the US presidential election, Hillary Clinton would have won in a landslide, with 437 electoral votes in her column. For many of us who grew up after the Cold War, who did not experience “history” but rather grew up in technocratic, globalized societies, there seems to be little nostalgia. Views can change, of course, but these demographic trends should be encouraging for anyone who fears a long-term resurgence of right-wing populism.

As we have seen, though, the trend moves in the opposite direction in Israel, where younger voters are more religious and conservative than their parents. Left-wing rallies are a sea of gray hair; right-wing protests are filled with youthful energy. A 2016 poll found that nearly half of Jewish high school students do not believe their Arab compatriots should have the right to vote. This difference cannot simply be attributed to the ongoing conflict with the Palestinians. A recurring theme in this book, after all, is the disconnect between Israel’s physical circumstances and its politics. The country has never been more prosperous, more secure, or more accepted in the world than it is today. Yet young Israeli Jews seem far more prone to right-wing views than their American or European counterparts—suggesting that there is another factor at work, a fundamental difference between Israel’s identity and the changing identities of Western societies.

A century ago, Zionism had a clear meaning: the desire to establish a homeland for the Jewish people in Palestine. It was not necessarily to be a “Jewish state”, however. Many of the early immigrants spoke instead of a “Hebrew state”, a new nation that would reject the superstitions and